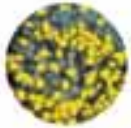


Rock gardens

When the snow melts in spring, the grassy meadows on high mountains are ablaze with flowers.



Mountain daisy These bloom in their thousands across alpine meadows.



Rock spiraea Creamy-white flowers form dense mats over rocky areas.



Thyme Low, thick clumps of miniature thyme make a colourful appearance.



Saxifrage There are many different colours of this hardy plant.



Edelweiss In many places, this plant is now protected: you can't pick it.



Alpine snowbell Tiny bell-shaped flowers push their way up in early spring.

Gelada baboons



Who needs a tree!

Some monkeys prefer cliffs to trees! Gelada baboons actually sleep on cliffs, perched on the narrowest ledges.

ibex



This is my home

Ibex are goats. They can scramble up the steepest slopes and leap about without losing their footing.

Alpine chough



Life in thin air

Mountain air is so thin that mountaineers need oxygen tanks, but birds like the chough have no problem breathing it. A chough once accompanied a climbing expedition to the summit of Mount Everest.